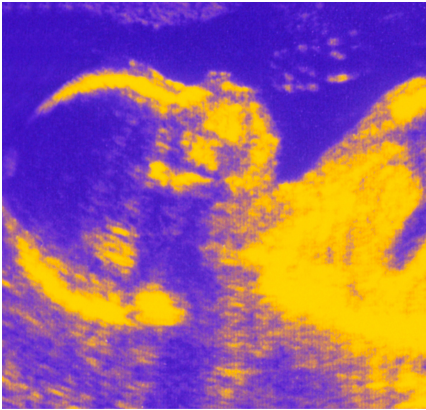




YOU ARE **16 WEEKS AND 2 DAYS**

166 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

In this color 2-D ultrasound scan the baby is facing upward. The skull bones reflect the ultrasound beam most effectively and show as bright areas. The curved frontal bone of the forehead is seen just above the short nasal bone forming the bridge of the nose.

“Your baby is at his most mobile about now, and he may even be doing somersaults in your uterus.”

There are several ways in which your baby can now move: they can curl and stretch their trunk, move their head up and down and from side to side, and move their arms and legs independently. Regular chest wall breathing movements occur, along with occasional hiccups. The mouth can open and shut, and your baby can yawn and swallow amniotic fluid. The hands can be brought up to the face and the baby may prefer lying on their side rather than back. They have plenty of space in which to move.

Your baby's taste buds first appeared at 10 weeks and by now have an appearance very close to that of a mature taste bud. They also have their own nerve supply, connected to a branch of the facial nerve. Because these neural connections have not yet matured, it is too early for your baby to be able to taste anything.

FOCUS ON TWINS

By now, you may be starting to feel your twin babies move. Contact between them probably began a few weeks ago, long before you knew about it, and it becomes more complex as their brains develop. By this stage, babies have the elementary brain circuits that help them feel the parts of their body and appreciate their position, so it's no wonder that your babies can now interact at a basic level.

Your babies will move around 50 times an hour and can touch each other, even though in all but a tiny percentage of cases they're in separate amniotic sacs so there's a membrane between them. Ultrasound studies show that twin babies make physical contact and sometimes react to each other's touch and pressure.